

HTTP Response Status Codes

universal handshake language

HTTP status codes are three-digit numbers sent by a server to a client (like a browser or app) after receiving an HTTP request. They tell the client what happened with that request — whether it succeeded, failed, was redirected, or needs more action.

Status Code

1xx / 2xx / 3xx / 4xx / 5xx

1xx Informational

Rare

server has received the request and is continuing to process it.

100 Continue

101 Switching Protocols

102 Processing

2xx Success

These codes mean the request was received, understood, and successfully processed

200 OK Everything OK, data returned successfully

201 Created New resource created successfully (usually with POST)

204 No Content Operation succeeded but no content returned like in the Preflight or delete Request

3xx Redirection

These codes mean that the requested resource has moved to another location or the client needs to take an additional step.

301 Moved Permanently Resource has permanently moved to a new URL

302 Found / Moved Temporarily Resource has temporarily moved

304 Not Modified Resource hasn't changed → use cached version

Client Error

4xx

400 Bad Request Server cannot understand the request due to bad syntax or missing data

401 Unauthorized Requires login or valid authentication token

403 Forbidden Logged in but your account doesn't have permission

404 Not Found The requested resource or page is not found on the server

405 Method Not Allowed The HTTP method used is not allowed for this resource

409 Conflict The server received the request but there's a conflict with the current state of the resource, usually due to duplicate creation or modification.

429 Too Many Requests The client has sent too many requests in a short period, and the server temporarily blocks further requests (rate limiting).



Commonly appears in APIs to protect against spam or DDoS attacks.

Server Error

5xx

500 Internal Server Error Unexpected server error or bug preventing request

501 Not Implemented Server cannot execute the requested method

502 Bad Gateway Server acting as a gateway received invalid response

503 Service Unavailable Server overloaded, down, or under maintenance

504 Gateway Timeout Server acting as a gateway did not receive a timely response

505 HTTP Version Not Supported Server does not support the HTTP protocol version

Client requests data from a large site → Load balancer forwards request to internal server → internal server is too slow or unresponsive → Load balancer responds 504 Gateway Timeout.



Load Balancer

Client requests a page from a site using a load balancer → Load balancer forwards request to internal server → internal server is down → Load balancer responds 502 Bad Gateway.